

Absolutely — **fortune** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “It would **cost a fortune**...”

Here **a fortune** means **a very large amount of money**, not “luck” or “fate”. But **fortune** also has major meanings involving **wealth, luck, fate, future prediction, and changing personal circumstances**.

Word family: **fortune / fortunate / fortunately / unfortunate / unfortunately**

Base word: fortune

Related adjectives: fortunate, unfortunate

Adverbs: fortunately, unfortunately

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Your source phrase:

> “It would **cost a fortune**...”

Meaning in your passage: **a fortune = a very large amount of money — 一大筆錢 ; 巨款**

Here **fortune** means:

> **a very large amount of money.**

繁體中文 :

數額非常龐大的一筆金錢 ; 巨款

Natural translation:

> “It would cost a fortune.”

「那會**花上一大筆錢 / 貴得驚人**。」

So here:

> **a fortune = 一大筆錢**

This is a very common conversational use.

1. **a fortune = a very large amount of money — 一大筆錢 ; 巨款**

Your exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “It would **cost a fortune**.”

「那會**花上一大筆錢**。」

Practice 2

> “That painting must be worth a fortune.”

「那幅畫一定**價值連城 / 值一大筆錢**。」

Practice 3

> “She spent a fortune renovating the house.”

「她花了**一大筆錢**翻新房子。」

a fortune = 非常龐大的金錢數額

Common patterns:

* cost a fortune

* spend a fortune

* pay a fortune

* be worth a fortune

2. **fortune = great wealth / accumulated money and property — 財產；巨額財富**

A major noun meaning.

Practice 4

> “He made his **fortune** in technology.”

「他靠科技業**賺得巨額財富 / 發跡致富**。」

Practice 5

> “She inherited a large fortune.”

「她繼承了一大筆**財產**。」

****fortune = 一個人累積或擁有的大量金錢和財產****

This is broader than one expensive purchase.

3. ****make a fortune = 發財；賺大錢****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 6

> “The artist never expected to ****make a fortune**** from his work.”

「那位藝術家從沒想過會靠自己的作品****賺大錢****。」

Practice 7

> “He made a fortune selling property.”

「他靠出售物業****發了財****。」

****make a fortune = 累積大量財富；賺到很多錢****

4. ****lose a fortune = 損失一大筆錢****

Practice 8

> “They ****lost a fortune**** on the failed project.”

「他們在失敗的項目上****損失了一大筆錢****。」

Practice 9

> “He nearly lost a fortune in the market.”

「他差點在市場上****損失巨款****。」

****lose a fortune = 損失非常龐大的金錢****

5. ****fortune = luck, especially good or bad luck — 運氣；際遇****

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 10

> “She had the good **fortune** to meet the artist.”

「她很**幸運**有機會遇到那位藝術家。」

Practice 11

> “By a stroke of fortune, the painting was recovered.”

「因為一次**幸運的機緣**，那幅畫被找回來了。」

****fortune = 影響事情結果的運氣或際遇****

This can be:

* good fortune = 好運

* bad fortune / misfortune = 厄運、不幸

6. ****good fortune = 好運；幸運****

Practice 12

> “We had the ****good fortune**** to visit the museum on a quiet day.”

「我們很**幸運**在一個安靜的日子參觀博物館。」

Practice 13

> “Her success involved both skill and good fortune.”

「她的成功既靠實力，也有**好運**。」

****good fortune = 有利而幸運的際遇****

More formal/literary than simple ****luck****.

7. ****fortune = fate / what happens in someone's life — 命運；人生際遇****

A more formal/literary sense.

Practice 14

> “His **fortune** changed completely after the war.”

「戰後，他的**命運 / 人生際遇**徹底改變。」

Practice 15

> “The novel follows the fortunes of one family.”

「這部小說講述一個家庭的**命運起伏**。」

fortune = 一個人、家庭、組織等隨時間發生的命運和處境變化

This is especially common in plural:

> **fortunes**

8. **fortunes = changing success/circumstances — 興衰；命運起伏；境況**

A very useful plural meaning.

Practice 16

> “The company’s **fortunes** improved after the new product launch.”

「新產品推出後，公司的**境況 / 業績命運**有所改善。」

Practice 17

> “The exhibition traces the changing fortunes of the artist.”

「展覽追溯這位藝術家的**人生興衰 / 際遇變化**。」

fortunes = 某人 / 機構一段時間內的成功、失敗和境況變化

Natural Chinese:

* 命運起伏

* 興衰

* 境況

* 運勢

depending on context.

9. **fortune = prediction of someone's future — 運程；未來命運的預測**

A distinct divination meaning.

Practice 18

> “She had her **fortune** told.”

「她去找人**算命**。」

Practice 19

> “The fortune predicted a major change in his life.”

「那個**命運預測 / 算命結果**說他的人生會出現重大變化。」

fortune = 對一個人未來命運的預測

Most often in:

> tell someone's fortune

10. **fortune-teller = 算命師；占卜師**

A useful family compound.

Practice 20

> “The **fortune-teller** predicted that she would travel abroad.”

「**算命師 / 占卜師**預言她會到海外旅行。」

Practice 21

> “He does not believe in fortune-tellers.”

「他不相信**算命師**。」

fortune-teller = 聲稱能預測別人未來或命運的人

11. **fortune-telling = 算命；占卜**

Practice 22

> “Fortune-telling has a long history in many cultures.”

「**算命 / 占卜**在許多文化中都有悠久歷史。」

Practice 23

> “The festival included traditional fortune-telling.”

「節慶中包括傳統**占卜活動**。」

fortune-telling = 預測某人未來 / 命運的活動

12. **fortune cookie = 幸運餅；籤語餅**

A lexicalized compound.

Practice 24

> “She opened the **fortune cookie** after dinner.”

「她飯後打開了一個**幸運餅 / 籤語餅**。」

Practice 25

> “The message inside the fortune cookie was funny.”

「那個**幸運餅**裡的籤語很好笑。」

fortune cookie = 內藏一張短句 / 預言紙條的脆餅

13. **fortune = chance/opportunity created by circumstances — 機緣；際遇**

This is related to luck, but often focuses on a favourable circumstance.

Practice 26

> “I had the **fortune** of seeing the original painting in person.”

「我有幸親眼看到那幅原作。」

Practice 27

> “Few people have the fortune to work with such a talented mentor.”

「很少人有這樣的**機緣 / 幸運**與如此有才華的導師合作。」

have the fortune to/of = 有幸獲得某個難得機會 / 際遇

Register:

* formal

* literary

14. **fortunate** = lucky / having a favourable result — 幸運的

A major related adjective.

Practice 28

> “We were **fortunate** to get tickets.”

「我們很**幸運**買到票。」

Practice 29

> “She was fortunate enough to study abroad.”

「她很**幸運**有機會到海外升學。」

fortunate = 因有利的機會、結果或情況而幸運的

Common pattern:

> fortunate to + verb

> fortunate enough to + verb

15. **fortunate** = favourable / beneficial — 有利的；幸運的

A slightly more formal contextual use.

Practice 30

> “It was a **fortunate coincidence**.”

「那是一個**幸運的巧合**。」

Practice 31

> “The timing was extremely fortunate.”

「那個時機非常**有利 / 幸運**。」

fortunate = 某個情況碰巧帶來良好結果

16. **fortunately** = luckily — 幸好；幸運的是

Practice 32

> “**Fortunately**, the painting was not damaged.”

「**幸好**那幅畫沒有受損。」

Practice 33

> “Fortunately, we arrived before the museum closed.”

「**幸好**我們在博物館閉館前抵達。」

fortunately = 用來表示某件好事幸運地發生 / 壞事沒有發生

17. **unfortunate** = unlucky / regrettable — 不幸的；令人遺憾的

Practice 34

> “It was an **unfortunate accident**.”

「那是一宗**不幸的事故**。」

Practice 35

> “The timing was unfortunate.”

「那個時機很**不巧 / 不理想**。」

unfortunate = 帶來不好結果、令人遺憾或不幸的

18. **unfortunate = person affected by bad circumstances (較正式 / 較舊) — 不幸的人**

As a noun, usually plural:

Practice 36

> “The charity provided food for the less fortunate.”

「慈善機構為**生活較不幸 / 較弱勢的人**提供食物。」

Practice 37

> “He wanted to help those less fortunate than himself.”

「他希望幫助那些**處境比自己困難的人**。」

the less fortunate = 處境較差、資源較少或生活較困難的人

This is a common modern expression.

19. **unfortunately = unfortunately / regrettably — 不幸地；可惜；遺憾的是**

Practice 38

> “**Unfortunately**, the museum was closed.”

「**可惜 / 不幸的是**，博物館關門了。」

Practice 39

> “Unfortunately, the original was too expensive.”

「**可惜**原作太昂貴了。」

unfortunately = 用來引出令人失望、不利或不幸的事實

Important distinction: **fortune vs luck**

luck

the most common general word:

= 運氣

fortune

often more formal/literary and can imply:

* luck

* fate

* life circumstances

> “Good luck!”

= 祝你好運！

More natural than:

> *Good fortune!*

> in ordinary conversational wishes.

But:

> “By good fortune, nobody was hurt.”

= 幸運的是，沒有人受傷。

Important distinction: **fortune vs fate**

fortune

can mean changing luck/circumstances.

fate

often suggests an outcome that is destined or beyond human control.

> changing fortunes

> = 不斷變化的際遇

> fate

> = 命中注定的命運

So they overlap, but **fate** has a stronger “destiny” idea.

Important distinction: **fortune vs wealth**

wealth

= abundance of money/assets generally.

fortune

= a very large amount of accumulated wealth.

> “She has considerable wealth.”

= 她很富有。

> “She inherited a fortune.”

= 她繼承了一大筆財產。

Fortune usually sounds like a large, identifiable amount of wealth.

Important distinction: **fortune vs money**

money

general term.

a fortune

emphatic:

an exceptionally large amount.

> “It costs money.”

= 要花錢。

> “It costs a fortune.”

= 要花一大筆錢 / 貴得驚人。

Important distinction: **cost a fortune vs be worth a fortune**

Directly relevant to your passage.

cost a fortune

= requires a huge amount of money to buy/do.

be worth a fortune

= has extremely high monetary value.

> “The original costs a fortune.”

= 買原作要花巨款。

> “The original is worth a fortune.”

= 原作本身價值極高。

Different perspective.

Important distinction: **make a fortune vs earn money**

earn money

= make income.

make a fortune

= become very wealthy / earn an exceptionally large amount.

> “She earns money from art.”

= 她靠藝術賺錢。

> “She made a fortune from art.”

= 她靠藝術賺了一大筆錢 / 發了財。

Important distinction: **fortune — wealth vs fortune — luck**

Same noun, very different meaning.

Wealth:

> “He inherited a fortune.”

= 他繼承巨額財產。

Luck:

> “He had the good fortune to survive.”

= 他很幸運地活了下來。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **fortune — luck vs fortunes — circumstances**

Singular:

> good fortune

> = 好運

Plural:

> changing fortunes

> = 不斷變化的境況 / 興衰

Plural **fortunes** very often refers to:

> success, failure, prosperity, decline over time.

Important distinction: **fortunate vs lucky**

lucky

more conversational/general.

fortunate

slightly more formal and often used with situations/opportunities.

> “I was lucky to find it.”

> “I was fortunate to find it.”

Both:

「我很幸運找到它。」

But **fortunate** is somewhat more formal.

Important distinction: **fortunate vs successful**

fortunate

= benefited from luck/circumstances.

successful

= achieved the desired result.

Someone can be:

* fortunate but not successful;

* successful through skill rather than luck.

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **unfortunate vs unlucky**

unlucky

focuses on bad luck.

unfortunate

can mean either:

* unlucky;
* regrettable/unpleasant.

> “an unlucky player”
> = 運氣不好的球員

> “an unfortunate comment”
> = 一句不恰當 / 令人遺憾的評論

The latter does not necessarily involve luck.

Important distinction: **unfortunate vs regrettable**

unfortunate

broader and can describe an unlucky situation.

regrettable

specifically means deserving regret.

> unfortunate accident
> = 不幸事故

> regrettable decision
> = 令人遺憾的決定

Overlap exists.

Important distinction: **fortune-telling vs prediction**

prediction

general forecast based on evidence, models, opinion, etc.

fortune-telling

specifically predicts personal future through divination/supernatural methods.

So:

> weather prediction ≠ fortune-telling

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **a fortune — huge amount of money** = 一大筆錢 / 巨款
- * **fortune — accumulated wealth** = 巨額財富 / 財產
- * **make a fortune** = 發財 / 賺大錢
- * **lose a fortune** = 損失一大筆錢
- * **fortune — luck** = 運氣 / 際遇
- * **good fortune** = 好運
- * **fortune — fate** = 命運 / 人生際遇
- * **fortunes — changing circumstances** = 興衰 / 境況 / 命運起伏
- * **fortune — future prediction** = 運程 / 算命結果
- * **fortune-teller** = 算命師 / 占卜師
- * **fortune-telling** = 算命 / 占卜
- * **fortune cookie** = 幸運餅 / 籤語餅
- * **have the fortune to/of** = 有幸.....
- * **fortunate** = 幸運的
- * **fortunately** = 幸好 / 幸運的是
- * **unfortunate** = 不幸的 / 令人遺憾的
- * **the less fortunate** = 處境較困難 / 較弱勢的人
- * **unfortunately** = 不幸的是 / 可惜

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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a fortune — money amount	數額非常龐大的一筆金錢；巨款
fortune — wealth	一個人累積或擁有的大量金錢及財產
make a fortune	累積巨額財富；發財 / 賺大錢
lose a fortune	損失非常龐大的金錢
fortune — luck	影響事情結果的好運、壞運或際遇
good fortune	有利而幸運的際遇 / 好運
fortune — fate	一個人或團體人生 / 發展中的命運與際遇
fortunes	某人 / 機構一段時間內成功、失敗和境況的變化
fortune — divination	對某人未來命運所作的預測
fortune-teller	聲稱能預測他人命運或未來的人
fortune-telling	透過占卜等方式預測個人未來的活動
fortunate	因機會、情況或結果有利而幸運的
fortunately	表示好事幸運地發生，或壞事沒有發生
unfortunate	帶來不好結果、令人遺憾或不幸的

the less fortunate	處境較差、資源較少或生活較困難的人	
unfortunately	用來引出令人失望、不利或不幸的事實	

For your original sentence

> “It would **cost a fortune**, probably far beyond anything I could ever afford.”

The exact meaning is:

a fortune = 買 Monet 原作所需的一筆極其龐大的金錢

Natural translation:

> **「那肯定要花上一大筆錢，恐怕遠遠超出我能負擔的範圍。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **cost a fortune** → 花一大筆錢 / 非常昂貴
- > **be worth a fortune** → 價值連城 / 值很多錢
- > **make a fortune** → 發財 / 賺大錢
- > **inherit a fortune** → 繼承巨額財產
- > **good fortune** → 好運
- > **changing fortunes** → 命運起伏 / 興衰
- > **tell someone's fortune** → 替某人算命
- > **fortunate** → 幸運的
- > **fortunately** → 幸好
- > **unfortunate** → 不幸的 / 令人遺憾的